

Wednesday, 16 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 19° 14°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 18° 13°	MANCHESTER Light rain 16° 13°	GLASGOW Drizzle 16° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Two people have tragically died after a car collided with a group of pedestrians in Doncaster.

Police say the vehicle then hit two other cars on White Rose Way. Emergency services are still on the scene, and investigations are ongoing.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 2

The number of small boat crossings in the Channel has reportedly fallen, with law enforcement agencies crediting their efforts.

However, officials also acknowledge that broader international developments, particularly in the Middle East, may have played a part. It's a complex issue with multiple factors at play.

IMMIGRATION · UK
- 3

Unions are urging the government to reconsider planned changes to immigration rules, which would significantly alter the path to permanent residence.

The Home Secretary wants to double the time it takes for most migrants to qualify. Unions argue these tougher measures could have a detrimental impact.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

Pubs across England and Wales will now be able to accept digital ID apps as proof of age, alongside traditional physical documents.

The new rules came into effect yesterday, offering a modern alternative for verifying age. It could make things a little easier for both customers and venues.

LAW · UK
- 5

North Sea oil and gas bosses claim the UK could unlock 100 more projects, potentially supplying half its energy needs without imports.

A new report from OEUK suggests this is possible if the government offers more support to the sector. It's a significant claim in the ongoing energy debate.

ENERGY · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Huge congratulations to Welsh actor Matthew Rhys, who made Emmy Awards history with a double win!**
He became the first person ever to scoop two lead acting prizes in one night at the prestigious TV ceremony. A truly incredible achievement for the talented star.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Matthew Rhys role? The Americans, Brothers & Sisters, or something else?
AWARDS · YESTERDAY

- 2 The Emmy Awards celebrated the best of US television last night, with some big names taking home the top prizes.**
Zendaya, Sarah Snook, and Colman Domingo were among the stars honoured for their acting. It was a glittering night for the small screen.

ON AIR – What was your favourite TV show of the last year? Did it win big at the Emmys?
AWARDS · YESTERDAY

- 3 The stars were out in force on the Emmys red carpet last night, with Selena Gomez and Zendaya among those lighting up the event.**
Celebrities walked a striking blue carpet ahead of the ceremony, showcasing some stunning fashion choices. It's always a highlight of awards season.

ON AIR – Who do you think is always best dressed on the red carpet?
AWARDS · YESTERDAY

- 4 Reading and Leeds Festival has unveiled a major overhaul for next year, hoping to draw in a new crowd.**
Organisers are making significant changes to the line-up and experience. It's an attempt to broaden the appeal of the iconic music festivals.

ON AIR – Have you ever been to Reading or Leeds? What's your favourite festival memory?
MUSIC · COMING UP

- 5 A city market has been transformed into a CBeebies TV set for a new show aimed at young children.**
Filmed in Coventry, the programme helps kids explore food through their senses. It sounds like a fun and educational new series!

ON AIR – What was your favourite children's TV show when you were growing up?
CHILDREN'S TV · COMING UP

On the schedule

- 1 The Women's Super League is back in full swing, and we've got all the goals from Matchweek Two!**
It was another exciting round of fixtures, with plenty of action across the league. You can catch up on all the best moments and top strikes.
ON AIR – Which WSL team are you backing this season?
FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 Great Britain's top cycling talents, including Tom Pidcock and Zoe Backstedt, will lead the charge at the Road World Championships.**
The team is packed with medal hopefuls, ready to compete on the global stage. It's set to be a thrilling event for British cycling fans.
ON AIR – Are you a keen cyclist? What's your favourite route?
CYCLING · GLOBAL
- 3 Wales manager Craig Bellamy has handed a first call-up to Cardiff City forward Cian Ashford for the Nations League campaign.**
However, they will be without key defender Joe Rodon, who is absent from the squad. It's an exciting opportunity for Ashford to make his mark.
ON AIR – Who do you think is the most exciting young talent in Welsh football right now?
FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Premier League teenagers Ceadach O'Neill and Braiden Graham have retained their places in Northern Ireland's squad.**
They'll be part of the team for the upcoming Nations League quadruple-header. It's fantastic to see young talent getting their chance on the international stage.
ON AIR – Who is your favourite Northern Ireland player, past or present?
FOOTBALL · UK
- 5 Former world number four Jack Draper has decided not to play again this season, but is aiming for a strong return next year.**
Draper has been battling injury and is focusing on his recovery. Fans will be hoping to see him back on court at the start of next season.
ON AIR – Who's your favourite British tennis player?
TENNIS · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A charming trend is sweeping through local parks: 'community picnic blanket' schemes.**
These initiatives see large, shared picnic blankets left in accessible spots for anyone to use, fostering spontaneous outdoor gatherings and neighbourly chats.
- 2 The delightful art of 'embroidering tiny positive messages' onto handkerchiefs is gaining popularity.**
People are stitching uplifting words onto small cloths and leaving them as random acts of kindness for strangers to discover.
- 3 A new study suggests that the sound of 'distant church bells' is one of Britain's most cherished calming sounds.**
Researchers found that the gentle peal evokes a sense of peace and nostalgia for many, proving more relaxing than modern ambient noises.
- 4 The unexpected hobby of 'identifying cloud formations' is bringing joy to amateur meteorologists.**
Enthusiasts are finding peace and wonder in naming and categorising the various shapes and types of clouds they observe daily.
- 5 Cafés across the country are introducing 'kindness coffee cups' with uplifting quotes printed inside.**
The idea is to give customers a little boost of positivity with their morning brew, revealed only as they finish their drink.
- 6 Gardeners are discovering the therapeutic benefits of 'talking to their plants', even if just for a few minutes a day.**
While scientific evidence is mixed, many report feeling a deeper connection to their garden and believe it encourages plant growth.
- 7 The simple pleasure of 'watching the sunrise with a hot cup of tea' is becoming a favoured morning ritual.**
More people are waking up a little earlier to embrace the quiet beauty of dawn, finding it a peaceful start to a busy day.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of chocolate will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE SNIFF, HOPING FOR THAT PERFECT COCOA AROMA.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new book, especially if it's a big novel. What is it?

ANSWER: FLICKING THROUGH ALL THE PAGES FIRST, JUST TO GET A FEEL FOR THE LENGTH!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday household chore' just feels oddly satisfying to complete, almost therapeutic?

Is there a specific chore, like hoovering, polishing, or even just organising a drawer, that you find genuinely enjoyable or calming once it's done?

- We all have that 'one particular type of biscuit' that, no matter what, is always the perfect companion to a hot cup of tea or coffee, don't we?

What's your ultimate go-to biscuit, and what is it about it that makes it so utterly perfect for dunking or just enjoying on its own?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is officially called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of squirrels is officially called a 'scurry'?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to eradicate the Black Death by destroying the rat-infested buildings.
- The world's smallest chameleon, the *Brookesia micra*, can fit comfortably on the tip of a human finger.
- The 'king' in a deck of playing cards is the only one without a moustache, except for the King of Hearts.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, reaching altitudes of around 9,000 metres.
- The first ever recorded 'snail mail' literally involved sending a letter by attaching it to a snail in the 19th century.
- Wombat poo is cube-shaped, which stops it from rolling away when they mark their territory.
- The British Isles have more than 6,500 miles of coastline, which is longer than the entire coastline of Brazil.
- The 'penny-farthing' bicycle was so named because the two wheels resembled a large penny and a small farthing coin.

On this day

Day 259 of the year, 106 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Andrew Kim Taegon; Christian feast day: Curcodomus; Christian feast day: Cyprian (Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Edith of Wilton. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — Joel Heyman, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1946 — Sonny LeMaire, American country music singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1948 — Susan Ruttan, American actress
- 1976 — Tina Barrett, English singer-songwriter, dancer, and actress
- 1968 — Marc Anthony, American singer-songwriter, actor, and producer
- 1944 — Linda Kaye Henning, American actress
- 1985 — Max Minghella, English actor
- 1992 — Chase Stokes, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1979 — Eight people escape from East Germany to the west in a homemade hot air balloon.
- 1979 — The Sugarhill Gang released their first single, Rapper's Delight.
- 2015 — A 8.3 Mw earthquake strikes the Chilean city of Illapel, killing 15 people, injuring at least 34, leaving at least six missing, and causing extensive damage. One person also dies in Argentina.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2004 — Hurricane Ivan makes landfall in Gulf Shores, Alabama as a Category 3 hurricane.
- 1975 — Cape Verde, Mozambique, and São Tomé and Príncipe join the United Nations.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2014 — The Islamic State of Iraq and the Levant launches its Kobani offensive against Syrian–Kurdish forces.
- 1979 — The Sugarhill Gang released their first single, Rapper's Delight.
- 1975 — The first prototype of the Mikoyan MiG-31 interceptor makes its maiden flight.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 260 of the year, 105 days left in 2026. Today Australian Citizenship Day; Christian feast day: Albert of Vercelli; Christian feast day: Ariadne of Phrygia; Christian feast day: Blessed Cecilia Eusepi. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1939 — Shelby Flint, American singer-songwriter and voice actress
- 1974 — Nona Gaye, American singer, model, and actress
- 1985 — Brendan Clarke, Irish footballer
- 1965 — Bryan Singer, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1946 — Billy Bonds, English footballer and manager (died 2025)
- 1986 — Sophie, English music producer, disc jockey and singer (died 2021)
- 1962 — Paul Feig, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1989 — Danielle Brooks, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1949 — The Canadian steamship SS Noronic burns in Toronto Harbour with the loss of over 118 lives.
- 1991 — Estonia, North Korea, South Korea, Latvia, Lithuania, the Marshall Islands and Micronesia join the United Nations.
- 2025 — Saudi Arabia and Pakistan sign the Strategic Mutual Defence Agreement.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1965 — The Battle of Chawinda is fought between Pakistan and India.
- 1948 — The Lehi (also known as the Stern gang) assassinates Count Folke Bernadotte, who was appointed by the United Nations to mediate between the Arab nations and Israel.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar